

to 90% and 1 hour 40 minutes to charge from 0% to 100%, with a standby time of up to 90 days. In terms of battery life, we get 16+ hours, if the rider is playing music at full volume. Our customers tell us that they have been able to complete a Bengaluru-Goa-Bengaluru round trip on a single charge,” explains PK.

The product, which is the first of its kind in India, is also manufactured and sold by other companies, such as SENA in North America and Europe, at a relatively higher price of around \$350 and for ₹35,000 in India. BluArmor has priced its product at ₹11,000 for the Indian market. Explaining the marketing plan, PK says that through the C30 the company intends to deliver a very premium experience to its early adopters and prepare the market for mass adoption. The company is also working with two-wheeler original equipment manufacturers to white-label its products to get the product into the larger market.

The design of the embedded hardware and firmware and the de-



Co-founder Srinivasan Chakravarthy (L) with founder and CEO Sundararajan Krishnan PK (R)

velopment of the mobile application happens at the company’s facility in Bommasandra, Bengaluru. The company has partnered with Mysore based electronics manufacturing services (EMS) company Kaynes Technology for the PCB assembly. The final product assembly and end-of-line testing happen at the Bengaluru facility itself. The company is currently seeking to partner with testing and measurement companies for its end-of-line testing, and competitive EMS partners as well.

The company has been funded

by Athera Venture Partners (formerly known as Inventus Capital India) and Karnataka Semiconductor Venture Fund (KITVEN).

Sharing valuable insights with EFY regarding his learnings from the challenges faced while developing the product, PK says, “When you launch a completely new technology in a mature market like India, you end up investing so much capital in educating the customer that it is near impossible for a startup to sustain itself. So it is important to at least operate in a space where the Indian customer is aware of the product you’ve built. The startup should not be counting on getting the customer educated with respect to the product offering and then selling it.”

With more than 2,000 customers since the product’s launch, the company is busy expanding its sales and taking feedback from existing customers to come up with the next generation of products with a pricing range that spans from entry to premium levels.

—Yashasvini Razdan

2 ‘FUELLING’ EVs WITH ALL THEIR ELECTRONICS NEEDS

Did you know that till around two years back, 90% of all the battery management systems—the brains of the batteries—that go into Indian electric two- and three-wheelers were procured from China? Ujjwal Bhardwaj, the CEO of Gurugram based Electrifuell, shared this fact and more, while claiming that startups like theirs are working to bridge that gap between the EV technology expectations and supply in India

When four college boys started to cut a second-hand Splendor motorcycle to fit a BLDC motor controller, a self-assembled battery and its management system, the by passers used to watch curiously. But why did the boys do so? “To bring the EV technology to the masses,” says Ujjwal Bhardwaj, one of the four boys and the CEO of an EV technology startup named Electrifuell, which was born



BMS variants—all are compliant with AIS 156 phase-1 and phase-2 regulations